

Statistical Mechanics I Exercise 3

Idan Stark

January 5, 2026

1 2D Lattice Gauge Theory

1.1 Low temperature expansion of the dual 3D Ising model

The Dual 3D Ising model is the 3D model where the spins sit on the edges of the lattice and not the vertices, and interact via the plaquette they sit on. In other words, four spins interact in each plaquette:

$$H = -J \sum_{\text{plaquettes}} \sigma_1^P \sigma_4^P \sigma_3^P \sigma_4^P \quad (1)$$

Where P is the index of the plaquette and the lower indices are the specific spin on the plaquette. We saw in class that the high-temperature expansion of this model is dual to the lower temperature expansion of the 3D Ising model. We shall now show that the low temperature expansion of this model is also dual to the high temperature expansion of the Ising model.

The low temperature expansion is done by starting from a ground state where all spins are either up or down. The partition function at temperature zero is:

$$Z_{T=0} = 2^{N+1} e^{12NK} \quad (2)$$

Where the factor 2 comes from the two options - all spins down and all spins up - and the factor 2^N comes from the gauge symmetry of the model, i.e. changing the spins on all edges touching a specific vertex will not change the total energy of the system. In general, we will take this factor for all terms in the expansion. The factor 12 in the exponent comes from each spin being a part of four plaquettes, and that there are $3N$ plaquettes in the model.

Now let us look for the smallest possible increments in energy. The three contenders are the flipping of one, two spins that share a plaquette, and three spins that share a vertex.

Let us start with one spin. This will flip the four plaquettes that include it, adding $8K$ to the total energy. There are $3N$ such spins to flip: 3 edges for each vertex in the lattice.

Next let us look at two spins that share a plaquette. To see why this is the lowest energy increment coming from two spins, let us see all our options. Flipping two spins can be either on the same plaquette or not on the same plaquette. On different plaquettes, this is the same as flipping one spin twice, and so adds $16K$ to the energy. On the other hand, If they share a plaquette, then they flip it twice, and so only the six plaquettes that they do not share flip. In this case the energy increment will be $12K$. It can be seen then that the more plaquettes the spins share, the less their combined energy increment will be. There are $3N$ plaquettes in the lattice, each of them there are $\binom{4}{2} = 6$ combinations of spins, therefore there are $18N$ such possible flips, which must also be reduced from the next step.

Lastly, let us attempt to flip three spins that share a vertex. We look at this case because the spins share the biggest amount of plaquettes, and so the energy increment in it will be minimal. Each of the three spins shares two of its plaquettes with another spin and has two additional plaquettes. All shared plaquettes flip twice, and so the effect cancels, and only the six unshared plaquettes flip. The energy increment is then $12K$, similar to two spin flip. There are N vertices in the lattice, each of them includes four configurations for the

positions of the flipped spins - 2 options for each direction are $2^3 = 8$ options, divided by 2 to remove the double counting, since each two opposite configurations are a gauge transformation apart, and we already accounted for it in the 2^N factor. The energy increments and their multiplicities are summarized in the table 1. The low temperature expansion is then

Flipped spins	Energy increment	Multiplicity
1	$8K$	$3N$
2 (sharing a plaquette)	$12K$	$18N$
3 (sharing a vertex)	$12K$	$4N$

Table 1: Energy increments and multiplicities for low temperature expansion of the dual 3D Ising model.

$$Z_{cold} = 2^{N+1} e^{12NK} (1 + 3Ne^{8K} + 22Ne^{12K} + \dots) \quad (3)$$

For comparison, the high temperature expansion of the 3D Ising model is:

$$Z_{high} = 2^N \cosh(K)^{3N} (1 + 3Ne^{4T} + 22Ne^{6T} + \dots) \quad (4)$$

Which shows that these two models are dual to each other.

1.2 The gauge transformation in 2D

Just like in the 3D case, the 2D case has a gauge symmetry: Flipping the spins on all four edges coming from a single vertex will cause each plaquette between them to be flipped twice, thus the total energy will stay the same. We can use this transformation to show that any configuration is energetically equivalent to a configuration in which all the horizontal spins are $\uparrow$ (calling $\uparrow = 1$ and $\downarrow = -1$ and ignoring the edges). First, let us notice that whenever there are two neighboring $\downarrow$ spins, we can flip the vertex between them, flipping the vertical spins while changing the horizontal spins to $\uparrow$. This means that for every uninterrupted chain of spins that are all $\downarrow$, we can flip them in pairs until none are left if the length of the chain is even and one left if the length of the chain is odd:

$$\begin{aligned} \uparrow\downarrow\downarrow\downarrow\uparrow\uparrow &\rightarrow \uparrow\uparrow\uparrow\downarrow\downarrow\uparrow \rightarrow \uparrow\uparrow\uparrow\uparrow\uparrow\uparrow \\ \uparrow\downarrow\downarrow\downarrow\downarrow\uparrow &\rightarrow \uparrow\uparrow\uparrow\downarrow\downarrow\uparrow \rightarrow \uparrow\uparrow\uparrow\uparrow\downarrow\uparrow \end{aligned}$$

Second, let us notice that we can "shift" single spins along the horizontal direction by flipping one of the vertices it touches:

$$\uparrow\downarrow\uparrow\uparrow\uparrow\uparrow \rightarrow \uparrow\uparrow\downarrow\uparrow\uparrow\uparrow \rightarrow \uparrow\uparrow\uparrow\downarrow\uparrow\uparrow$$

These two operations - "removing" pairs of spins and "shifting" a single spin along the line - allow us to "remove" all horizontal down spins. We simply "shift" the spins at the edges of groups one by one until they all touch each other, then cancel all of them out. Examples:

$$\begin{aligned} \uparrow\downarrow\downarrow\downarrow\uparrow\uparrow\downarrow\downarrow\downarrow &\xrightarrow{\text{shift}} \uparrow\uparrow\uparrow\uparrow\downarrow\downarrow\downarrow\downarrow\downarrow \xrightarrow{\text{remove}} \uparrow\uparrow\uparrow\uparrow\uparrow\uparrow\uparrow\uparrow\uparrow\uparrow \\ \downarrow\downarrow\uparrow\uparrow\uparrow\uparrow\downarrow\downarrow\downarrow &\xrightarrow{\text{shift}} \uparrow\uparrow\uparrow\uparrow\uparrow\uparrow\downarrow\downarrow\downarrow\downarrow \xrightarrow{\text{remove}} \uparrow\uparrow\uparrow\uparrow\uparrow\uparrow\uparrow\uparrow\uparrow\downarrow \end{aligned}$$

There is a caveat to this method. As can be seen in the second example above, in the case where a horizontal row has an odd number of spins, one spin will remain at the end. This spin can be pushed to the edge where it can be neglected, or, if the lattice has open boundary conditions, the gauge symmetry at the edge allows flipping it without flipping another horizontal spin, since at the edge there are only two plaquettes touching the vertex.

1.3 Solving the model in 2D

So, every state is energetically equivalent to another state with all horizontal spins up. This means that writing the partition function we can group the states by this equivalence relation, simply multiplying the partition function by the multiplicity of the horizontal line, and use the energy of the all-horizontal-spins-up state as the hamiltonian for all of the equivalent states:

$$Z = 2^{N_H} \sum_{\{\sigma_i\}} \prod_{\text{plaquette}} \exp[K\sigma_1^P \sigma_2^P] \quad (5)$$

Where N_H is the number of horizontal spins and σ_1^P and σ_2^P are the vertical spins in each plaquette. Now, this remains us of the 1D Ising model, but there is still a caveat - there are N_H chains, not one. But, since they do not interact, and since they are identical, we get:

$$Z = N_H 2^{N_H} \sum_{\{\sigma_i\}} \prod_{\langle i,j \rangle} \exp[K\sigma_i \sigma_j] \quad (6)$$

Which is exactly the 1D Ising model, up to a constant that will be removed by normalization. The value of the partition function is, using the developed in class using the transfer matrix method:

$$Z = N_H 2^{N_H + N_V} \cosh^{N_V}(K) \quad (7)$$

2 Umbrella Sampling in the 1D Ising Model

Let us consider the 1D Ising model with periodic boundary conditions:

$$H(\{\sigma_i\}) = -J \sum_{i=1}^N \sigma_i \sigma_{i+1} \quad (8)$$

with $J = 1$ and $N = 128$. At a temperature of $T = 2.5$ the magnetization distribution $P(m)$ is sharply peaked around $m = 0$. In this section we examine numeric evaluation methods for the distribution using Umbrella sampling.

2.1 Direct sampling

First, let us look at a direct sample. To do this, we ran a standard Monte-Carlo simulation with single-spin Metropolis dynamics. We ran the simulation with twenty samples running simultaneously. The system was first allowed to reach convergence. Convergence is defined by two criteria, and is considered reached only when both are met. The first is for the standard deviation of the averages of the twenty samples along the last ten repetitions to be under a threshold, defined to be 1. The second condition is for the slope of the average of the twenty samples along the last ten repetitions to be below a threshold defined to be 0.001. These two conditions measure convergence and stability, respectively.

The system reached convergence after twelve sweeps. It can be seen in the figure that the distribution is sharply peaked around $m = 0$, and that the tails of the distribution are very poorly sampled, with only a few samples in the ranges $|m| > 0.5$. In reality, only one sample was found in the range $|m| > 0.5$, and so the histogram bar is not visible in the figure.

This was expected, since at high temperatures the spins are disordered, leading to a magnetization probability peak around zero.

2.2 Using Umbrella potential

Now let us add the umbrella potential:

$$H_U = H + W(m) \quad W(m) = \frac{k}{2}(m - m_0)^2 \quad (9)$$

2.3 The umbrella sampling identity

As we saw in class, the actual probability $P(m)$ of a variable over a hamiltonian H can be related to a new hamiltonian $H_U = H + W$ using:

$$P(m) = e^{-\beta H(m)} = e^{-\beta H_U(m)} e^{\beta W(m)} = P_U(m) e^{\beta W(m)} \quad (10)$$

3 Yang-Lee zeros of the 1D Ising model

3.1 Rewriting the partition function

The partition function of the 1D Ising model can be written using the transfer matrix method:

$$Z_N = \lambda_+^N + \lambda_-^N \quad (11)$$

Where

$$\lambda_{\pm} = e^{\beta J} \cosh(\beta B) \pm \sqrt{e^{2\beta J} \cosh^2(\beta B) - 2 \sinh(2\beta J)} \quad (12)$$

Defining:

$$\rho = e^{-2\beta B} \quad \tau = e^{-2\beta J} \quad (13)$$

Then:

$$\begin{aligned} e^{\beta J} \cosh(\beta B) &= \frac{1}{\sqrt{\tau}} \frac{\frac{1}{\sqrt{\rho}} + \sqrt{\rho}}{2} = \frac{1 + \rho}{2\sqrt{\rho\tau}} \\ e^{2\beta J} \cosh^2(\beta B) &= \left(\frac{1 + \rho}{2\sqrt{\rho\tau}} \right)^2 = \frac{1 + 2\rho + \rho^2}{4\rho\tau} \\ 2 \sinh(2\beta J) &= e^{2\beta J} - e^{-2\beta J} = \frac{1 - \tau^2}{\tau} \end{aligned} \quad (14)$$

We get:

$$\lambda_{\pm} = \frac{1 + \rho}{2\sqrt{\rho\tau}} \pm \sqrt{\frac{1 + 2\rho + \rho^2}{4\rho\tau} - \frac{1 - \tau^2}{\tau}} = \frac{1 + \rho \pm \sqrt{(1 - \rho)^2 + (2\tau)^2} \rho}{2\sqrt{\rho\tau}} \quad (15)$$

So:

$$Z = \left(\frac{1 + \rho + \sqrt{(1 - \rho)^2 + (2\tau)^2} \rho}{2\sqrt{\rho\tau}} \right)^N + \left(\frac{1 + \rho - \sqrt{(1 - \rho)^2 + (2\tau)^2} \rho}{2\sqrt{\rho\tau}} \right)^N \quad (16)$$

3.2 Numerically solving the equation

Let us now find the values ρ for which $Z = 0$:

$$\left(\frac{1 + \rho + \sqrt{(1 - \rho)^2 + (2\tau)^2} \rho}{2\sqrt{\rho\tau}} \right)^N + \left(\frac{1 + \rho - \sqrt{(1 - \rho)^2 + (2\tau)^2} \rho}{2\sqrt{\rho\tau}} \right)^N = 0 \quad (17)$$

Moving λ_- to the other side

$$\left(\frac{1 + \rho + \sqrt{(1 - \rho)^2 + (2\tau)^2} \rho}{2\sqrt{\rho\tau}} \right)^N = - \left(\frac{1 + \rho - \sqrt{(1 - \rho)^2 + (2\tau)^2} \rho}{2\sqrt{\rho\tau}} \right)^N \quad (18)$$

Then dividing by it

$$\left(\frac{1 + \rho + \sqrt{(1 - \rho)^2 + (2\tau)^2 \rho}}{1 + \rho - \sqrt{(1 - \rho)^2 + (2\tau)^2 \rho}} \right)^N = -1 \quad (19)$$

And taking the N -th root:

$$\frac{1 + \rho + \sqrt{(1 - \rho)^2 + (2\tau)^2 \rho}}{1 + \rho - \sqrt{(1 - \rho)^2 + (2\tau)^2 \rho}} = e^{i\pi(2k+1)/N} \quad (20)$$

We get a quadratic equation for ρ . To solve it, let us multiply by the denominator, and move everything such that the root is isolated:

$$1 + \rho + \sqrt{(1 - \rho)^2 + (2\tau)^2 \rho} = e^{i\pi(2k+1)/N} \left(1 + \rho - \sqrt{(1 - \rho)^2 + (2\tau)^2 \rho} \right) \quad (21)$$

$$\left(e^{i\pi(2k+1)/N} + 1 \right) \sqrt{(1 - \rho)^2 + (2\tau)^2 \rho} = \left(e^{i\pi(2k+1)/N} - 1 \right) (1 + \rho) \quad (22)$$

$$\sqrt{(1 - \rho)^2 + (2\tau)^2 \rho} = \frac{e^{i\pi(2k+1)/N} - 1}{e^{i\pi(2k+1)/N} + 1} (1 + \rho) \quad (23)$$

Now, it's easy to see:

$$\frac{e^{i\pi(2k+1)/N} - 1}{e^{i\pi(2k+1)/N} + 1} = \frac{e^{i\pi(2k+1)/2N} - e^{i\pi(2k+1)/2N}}{e^{i\pi(2k+1)/2N} + e^{i\pi(2k+1)/2N}} = i \tan\left(\frac{2k+1}{2N}\pi\right) \equiv i\alpha_k \quad (24)$$

And so, we get:

$$\sqrt{(1 - \rho)^2 + (2\tau)^2 \rho} = i\alpha_k (1 + \rho) \quad (25)$$

$$(1 - \rho)^2 + (2\tau)^2 \rho = -\alpha_k^2 (1 + \rho)^2 \quad (26)$$

$$\rho^2 - 2\rho + 1 + 4\tau^2 \rho + \alpha_k^2 \rho^2 + 2\alpha_k^2 \rho + \alpha_k^2 = 0 \quad (27)$$

$$(1 + \alpha_k^2)\rho^2 + (4\tau^2 - 2 + 2\alpha_k^2)\rho + (1 + \alpha_k^2) = 0 \quad (28)$$

$$\rho^2 + \frac{4\tau^2 - 2 + 2\alpha_k^2}{1 + \alpha_k^2} \rho + 1 = 0 \quad (29)$$

And so we got a quadratic equation for ρ . Solving it will give the values of ρ for which $Z = 0$. Figure 1 shows the zeros on the complex plain for $N = 10, 50, 500$ and $\tau = 0.5$.

3.3 Very high β

Let us look at the regime where $\beta \rightarrow \infty$, or in other words, $T \rightarrow 0$. We expect there to be a phase transition in the system where sufficient B , or in other words, sufficiently small ρ , will cause the system to move between the two ground states - all spins up and all spins down. From the symmetry of the system, it is expected that the transition will be at $B = 0$.

According to Yang-Lee theory, the value of ρ for which such transition will occur is the value on the real axis where the zeros of the partition function are condensed as $N \rightarrow \infty$. In our case, increasing β is mathematically equivalent to decreasing τ . The values of ρ for which $Z = 0$ for different values of τ are visible in figure 2. It can be seen that the closer τ is to zero, the closer the points are to touching on the positive side of the real axis, at $\rho = 1$, as expected.

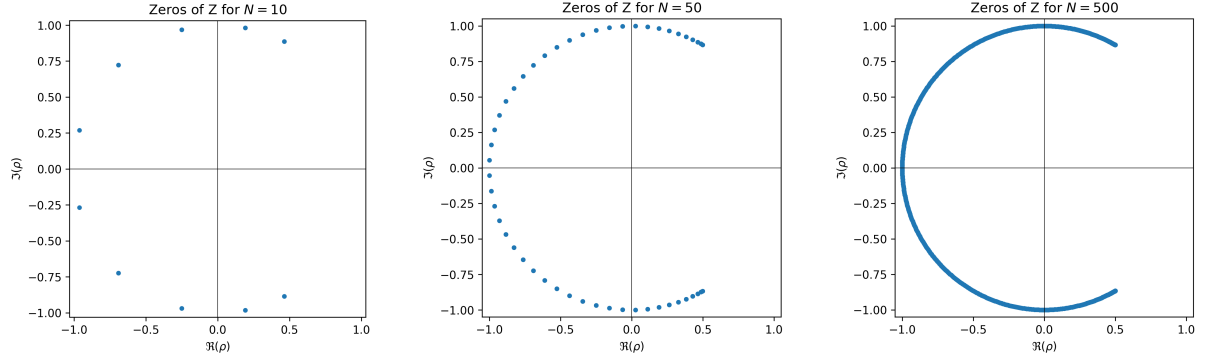


Figure 1: Complex values of ρ for which $Z = 0$ for $N = 10, 50, 500$ (from left to right) and $\tau = 0.5$

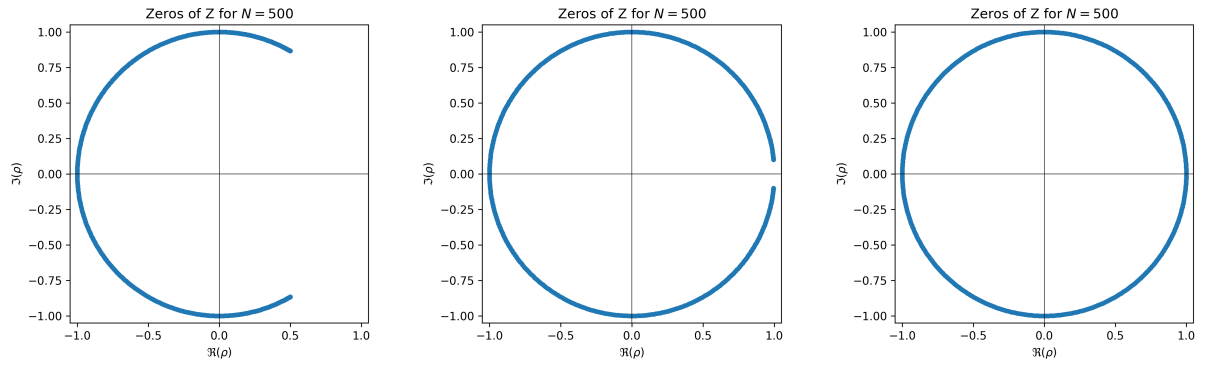


Figure 2: Complex values of ρ for which $Z = 0$ for $N = 500$ and $\tau = 0.5, 0.05, 0.005$ (from left to right)